

11-12-2024 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Bqnqjc4LoEQ
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Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Board/Council: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

Meeting Date: November 12, 2024 *(Inferred from agenda item timelines)*

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript contains no separate pre-meeting statutory public hearings or committee work sessions prior to the opening of the regular meeting.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by Presiding Officer President Williams. The opening included a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Heeter, Dr. Washford, Mr. Irvin, President Williams.
 - **Members Absent:** Dr. O'Neal, Mrs. Florence Griffin, Mr. Low (noted as attending a chamber meeting representing the school district).
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Williams.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance led by student participants.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the provided transcript text).*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:07:04 Presentation: Westview Elementary School Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric Ambler, Principal; Kelly Agu, Master Teacher; and Westview Elementary students.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Principal Ambler provided an enrollment and achievement overview, noting approximately 540 students, a 97% attendance rate, and roughly 90% teacher retention. Kelly Agu presented on the school's literacy initiatives, detailing Westview's participation in the Indiana Literacy Cadre 3, professional learning communities (PLC "Hooray Days"), peer learning walks, and implementation of structured early literacy practices (such as CKLA). Third-grade students and dual-language teachers also presented a reader's theater performance based on the ancient Roman civilization.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presentation only; no formal board action required.
- **00:39:18 Consent Agenda**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds / Board Leadership.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine consent agenda items and new hires introduced.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:39:43 Financial Report (October 2024)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grome (Chief Financial Officer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Grome presented the October financial results. Key figures included receipt of State Basic Grant revenue (projected over \$47 million total), an official October ADM enrollment count of 4,908 students, a slightly reduced employee count compared to the previous year, and an ending October cash balance of over \$29 million in the checkbook fund. Additionally, \$6 million in General Obligation bond proceeds closed and were added to fund balances. The state loan balance decreased to \$8.2 million (paying \$180,000 monthly).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:42:02 Resolution: Year-End Transfers & Rainy Day Fund Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grome.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for board permission to execute standard year-end account balancing transfers (bringing account balances to zero by year-end without exceeding allowed spending) and authorization for potential rainy day fund transfers of up to \$3 million in unobligated funds at the end of December.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:43:23 Title I Ed-Flex Waiver Application (Waivers 1 & 4)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Bell.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Bell presented an application to renew the Title I Ed-Flex waiver. Specifically, Waiver 1 permits increasing Title I carryover limits (allowing a carryover of up to 25% instead of the standard 15%), and Waiver 4 increases spending flexibility for Title IV funds above \$30,000 to better align district resources and student needs.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** The floor was opened for public comment pursuant to federal regulations. No public comments were brought forward. *(Note: Lighthearted courtroom anecdote shared by a board member regarding historical code of federal regulations enforcement).*
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:50:16 Public Hearing & Resolution: Additional Appropriations (Rainy Day & Education Funds)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grome / President Williams.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A statutory public hearing was opened to consider additional fourth-quarter appropriations of up to \$400,000 from the Rainy Day Fund (for capital repairs and operational expenses) and \$2.6 million from the Education Fund (for normal fourth-quarter operational expenses such as transportation, building maintenance, and custodial services).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Opened for public comment; no members of the public spoke. The public hearing was subsequently closed.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Additional appropriations resolution approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

The transcript does not record a general open public comment period or citizen forum near the conclusion of the meeting, aside from public hearing opportunities tied directly to specific agenda items (such as the Ed-Flex waiver and additional appropriations).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- Dr. Reynolds highlighted recent district events, including Veterans Day programs across schools, the new girls wrestling team's early success (placing 3 out of 12 teams at the Monroe Central invite with two champions), North Side students competing in the "We the People" Civics contest, Grome being awarded a Purple Heart distinction by the IDOE, and Ms. Ward being recognized by the city council as a Muncie difference-maker.
- President Williams praised the Westview Elementary staff and students and announced upcoming travel plans.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion by Mr. Irvin and approved by voice vote.

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